
title: "Kitchen Remodel Cost Breakdown: Real Numbers for Cabinets, Countertops & Everything Else" description: "Complete kitchen renovation cost breakdown with actual material prices, labor rates, and where contractors inflate quotes. Budget from \$15K to \$75K+ ." date: 2024-01-17 author: Ungouge Team keywords: ["kitchen remodel cost breakdown", "kitchen renovation cost", "kitchen remodel budget", "how much does kitchen remodel cost", "kitchen renovation prices"]

Kitchen Remodel Cost Breakdown: Real Numbers for Cabinets, Countertops & Everything Else

You want a new kitchen. You've gotten quotes ranging from \$25,000 to \$75,000 for what seems like the same work. How is that possible?

Kitchen remodels are notorious for price opacity. There are dozens of line items, multiple materials to choose from, and enough complexity that contractors can bury inflated costs where most homeowners will never find them.

This guide breaks down exactly what each component of a kitchen remodel should cost—from cabinets to countertops to the labor to install them. You'll know what's fair, what's padded, and where to push back.

Kitchen Remodel Cost Overview by Size

Before diving into itemized costs, here are realistic total budgets by kitchen size:

Kitchen Size	Budget Remodel	Mid-Range Remodel	High-End Remodel
Small (70-100 sq ft)	\$15,000-\$25,000	\$25,000-\$45,000	\$45,000-\$75,000 +
Medium (100-150 sq ft)	\$25,000-\$40,000	\$40,000-\$65,000	\$65,000-\$100,000 +
Large (150-200+ sq ft)	\$40,000-\$60,000	\$60,000-\$90,000	\$90,000-\$150,000 +

What defines each tier:

Budget: Stock cabinets, laminate countertops, basic appliances, vinyl flooring, minimal structural changes

Mid-Range: Semi-custom cabinets, quartz or granite countertops, quality appliances, tile or engineered hardwood flooring, some layout changes

High-End: Custom cabinets, premium countertops (marble, quartzite), high-end appliances, hardwood or luxury tile flooring, significant layout changes, designer lighting

The Itemized Breakdown: Where Your Money Goes

1. Cabinets (30-40% of total budget)

Cabinets are the single largest expense in most kitchen remodels. The price variation is enormous.

Stock Cabinets (Budget)

Cost: \$75-\$200 per linear foot - **Total for 20 linear feet:** \$1,500-\$4,000 - Pre-manufactured, standard sizes - Limited styles and finishes - Particle board or MDF construction - Basic hardware included

Brands: IKEA, Hampton Bay (Home Depot), Continental Cabinets

Semi-Custom Cabinets (Mid-Range)

Cost: \$150-\$400 per linear foot - **Total for 20 linear feet:** \$3,000-\$8,000 - More size and finish options - Better construction (plywood boxes) - Soft-close hinges and drawer glides - Dovetail drawer construction

Brands: KraftMaid, Merillat, American Woodmark, Thomasville

Custom Cabinets (High-End)

Cost: \$500-\$1,500+ per linear foot - **Total for 20 linear feet:** \$10,000-\$30,000+ - Any size, style, finish - Premium materials (solid wood, exotic veneers) - Hand-crafted details - Full customization

Brands: Local cabinet makers, Wood-Mode, Rutt, SieMatic

Installation Labor

Cost: \$50-\$100 per linear foot - **Total for 20 linear feet:** \$1,000-\$2,000 - Includes removal of old cabinets - Installation, leveling, securing - Hardware installation

Red flag: If installation labor exceeds \$125 per linear foot for standard cabinets, question it.

2. Countertops (10-15% of total budget)

Countertop pricing varies wildly by material, thickness, edge detail, and square footage.

Laminate (Budget)

Cost: \$10-\$40 per square foot installed - **50 sq ft kitchen:** \$500-\$2,000 - Affordable, many colors - Not heat-resistant - Can chip or peel over time

Tile (Budget-Mid)

Cost: \$15-\$50 per square foot installed - **50 sq ft kitchen:** \$750-\$2,500 - Durable, heat-resistant - Grout lines require maintenance - Can be DIY-friendly

Quartz (Mid-Range)

Cost: \$50-\$120 per square foot installed - **50 sq ft kitchen:** \$2,500-\$6,000 - Non-porous, low maintenance - Consistent color and pattern - Not heat-proof (hot pans can damage)

Brands: Caesarstone, Cambria, Silestone

Granite (Mid-Range)

Cost: \$40-\$100 per square foot installed - **50 sq ft kitchen:** \$2,000-\$5,000 - Natural stone, unique patterns - Requires periodic sealing - Heat-resistant

Marble (High-End)

Cost: \$75-\$250 per square foot installed - **50 sq ft kitchen:** \$3,750-\$12,500 - Luxurious, classic appearance - Stains and scratches easily - High maintenance

Quartzite (High-End)

Cost: \$70-\$200 per square foot installed - **50 sq ft kitchen:** \$3,500-\$10,000 - Natural stone, hard as granite - Marble-like appearance - Requires sealing

What's Included in "Installed" Price

- Template and measurement
- Fabrication (cutting, edge detail)
- Delivery and installation
- Seam sealing (if applicable)
- Sink cutout (first one)

Red flags: - Charging separately for "template fee" (\$200-\$400) when quote says "installed" - Fabrication charges that double the material cost - Seam charges over \$100 per seam - Edge detail upcharges over \$20 per linear foot for standard edges

3. Flooring (5-10% of total budget)

Kitchen flooring must handle traffic, spills, and temperature changes.

Vinyl/LVP (Budget)

Cost: \$2-\$7 per square foot installed - **150 sq ft kitchen:** \$300-\$1,050 - Waterproof, durable - Easy installation (can be DIY) - Good for resale value

Ceramic/Porcelain Tile (Mid-Range)

Cost: \$5-\$15 per square foot installed - **150 sq ft kitchen:** \$750-\$2,250 - Highly durable, waterproof - Cold underfoot (can add radiant heat) - Professional installation recommended

Engineered Hardwood (Mid-Range)

Cost: \$6-\$16 per square foot installed - **150 sq ft kitchen:** \$900-\$2,400 - Real wood look, more stable than solid - Not fully waterproof - Refinishable (limited times)

Solid Hardwood (High-End)

Cost: \$8-\$20 per square foot installed - **150 sq ft kitchen:** \$1,200-\$3,000 - Classic, timeless - Not recommended for kitchens (water damage risk) - Refinishable multiple times

Installation labor typically: \$2-\$5 per sq ft depending on complexity

Red flag: Charging \$10+ per square foot for vinyl installation. Standard LVP installation is \$2-\$3 per sq ft.

4. Backsplash (2-5% of total budget)

Backsplash is where style meets function—and where costs can escalate quickly.

Ceramic Tile (Budget)

Cost: \$7-\$15 per square foot installed - **40 sq ft backsplash:** \$280-\$600 - Standard subway tile or simple patterns - Durable, easy to clean

Glass Tile (Mid-Range)

Cost: \$15-\$40 per square foot installed - **40 sq ft backsplash:** \$600-\$1,600 - Reflective, modern look - More difficult to install (higher labor)

Natural Stone/Marble (High-End)

Cost: \$20-\$60 per square foot installed - **40 sq ft backsplash:** \$800-\$2,400 - Luxurious appearance - Requires sealing - Can stain from cooking splatters

Designer/Custom Tile (High-End)

Cost: \$30-\$100+ per square foot installed - **40 sq ft backsplash:** \$1,200-\$4,000+ - Handmade, artisan tiles - Unique patterns or mosaics - Labor-intensive installation

Installation labor: \$5-\$15 per sq ft depending on tile type and pattern complexity

Red flag: Simple subway tile installation labor over \$8 per sq ft. Standard is \$4-\$6 per sq ft.

5. Plumbing (5-10% of total budget)

Plumbing costs vary dramatically based on whether you're relocating fixtures or simply replacing them.

Sink Replacement (No Relocation)

Cost: \$200-\$600 - Disconnect old sink - Install new sink (undermount or drop-in) - Connect supply lines and drain - 2-4 hours of labor

Faucet Installation

Cost: \$150-\$350 - Remove old faucet - Install new faucet - Connect supply lines - Test for leaks - 1-2 hours of labor

Garbage Disposal Installation

Cost: \$150-\$400 - **Unit cost:** \$75-\$250 - **Labor:** \$75-\$150 - Electrical connection required - 1-2 hours

Dishwasher Installation

Cost: \$150-\$400 (labor only; appliance separate) - Connect water supply - Connect drain line - Level and secure unit - Test operation - 2-3 hours

Relocating Plumbing (Major Cost)

Cost: \$1,500-\$5,000+ depending on distance - Rerouting water supply lines - Relocating drain pipes - May require opening walls/floors - Requires permits and inspections

Typical plumber hourly rate: \$75-\$150 per hour (varies by region)

Red flag: Charging \$800 to install a sink when no relocation is involved. Standard installation is \$200-\$400.

6. Electrical (5-10% of total budget)

Kitchens require significant electrical work: outlets, lighting, appliance circuits.

Outlet Installation (Standard)

Cost: \$100-\$200 per outlet - Includes box, outlet, wiring (short run) - GFCI outlets (required in kitchens) - 1-2 hours per outlet

Under-Cabinet Lighting

Cost: \$250-\$800 total - LED strip lighting: \$30-\$60 per linear foot installed - Puck lights: \$50-

\$100 per light installed - Hardwired vs plug-in affects cost

Recessed Lighting

Cost: \$150-\$300 per light installed - Includes fixture, housing, trim - Wiring to switch - Cutting ceiling holes - 2-3 hours per light

Pendant/Chandelier Installation

Cost: \$100-\$300 per fixture (labor only) - Mounting electrical box - Wiring to switch - Hanging and securing fixture - 1-2 hours per fixture

Appliance Circuits (New)

Cost: \$300-\$800 per circuit - 240V for range/oven: \$400-\$800 - 120V for dishwasher/disposal: \$300-\$500 - Running wire from panel to location - Dedicated circuit required by code

Typical electrician hourly rate: \$75-\$150 per hour (varies by region)

Red flag: Charging \$500 to install a single standard outlet. Unless significant rewiring is needed, this is padding.

7. Labor (20-35% of total budget)

Beyond specialized trades (plumber, electrician), general contractor labor includes:

Demolition

Cost: \$1,000-\$3,000 for average kitchen - Remove old cabinets, countertops, flooring - Disconnect appliances - Haul away debris - Dumpster rental: \$400-\$800

Time: 1-3 days depending on scope

Drywall Repair/Painting

Cost: \$1,500-\$4,000 - Patching walls after cabinet removal - Skim coating/texturing - Priming and painting walls/ceiling - 2 coats of paint

Typical painting cost: \$2-\$6 per sq ft

General Carpentry

Cost: \$50-\$100 per hour - Trimwork and molding - Building custom shelving - Installing hardware - Miscellaneous adjustments

Red flag: "Labor" line items without specifics. Insist on breakdown by task and estimated hours.

8. Appliances (15-25% of budget if replacing all)

Appliance costs vary from basic to luxury:

Appliance	Budget	Mid-Range	High-End
Refrigerator	\$600-\$1,200	\$1,200-\$3,000	\$3,000-\$10,000 +
Range/Oven	\$400-\$800	\$800-\$2,500	\$2,500-\$8,000 +
Dishwasher	\$300-\$600	\$600-\$1,200	\$1,200-\$2,500 +
Microwave	\$100-\$300	\$300-\$800	\$800-\$2,000 +
Range Hood	\$200-\$500	\$500-\$1,500	\$1,500-\$5,000 +

Budget package (all appliances): \$2,000-\$4,000 **Mid-range package:** \$4,000-\$9,000 **High-end package:** \$9,000-\$30,000 +

Installation is typically extra: \$100-\$400 per appliance

Red flag: Contractors charging \$800 to install a dishwasher or range. Standard installation is \$150-\$400 unless significant modifications are needed.

Small vs. Medium vs. Large Kitchen Budgets

Small Kitchen Remodel (70-100 sq ft)

Budget-conscious (\$15,000-\$25,000): - Stock cabinets (12-15 linear ft): \$2,500-\$4,000 - Laminate countertops (30 sq ft): \$600-\$1,200 - Vinyl flooring (80 sq ft): \$500-\$800 - Ceramic tile backsplash (25 sq ft): \$300-\$500 - Budget appliances: \$2,000-\$3,500 - Basic plumbing/electrical updates: \$1,500-\$2,500 - Labor (demo, install, paint): \$5,000-\$8,000 - Permits/contingency: \$1,600-\$2,500

Mid-range (\$25,000-\$45,000): - Semi-custom cabinets: \$4,500-\$7,500 - Quartz countertops: \$2,000-\$3,500 - Luxury vinyl or tile flooring: \$800-\$1,500 - Glass or stone backsplash: \$800-\$1,500 - Mid-range appliances: \$3,500-\$6,000 - Plumbing/electrical upgrades: \$2,500-\$4,000 - Labor: \$7,500-\$12,000 - Permits/contingency: \$3,400-\$9,000

Medium Kitchen Remodel (100-150 sq ft)

Budget-conscious (\$25,000-\$40,000): - Stock cabinets (18-22 linear ft): \$3,500-\$6,000 - Laminate/tile countertops (45 sq ft): \$1,000-\$2,000 - Vinyl flooring (120 sq ft): \$700-\$1,200 - Ceramic backsplash (35 sq ft): \$400-\$700 - Budget appliances: \$2,500-\$4,000 - Plumbing/electrical: \$2,000-\$3,500 - Labor: \$8,000-\$13,000 - Permits/contingency: \$3,900-\$7,600

Mid-range (\$40,000-\$65,000): - Semi-custom cabinets: \$6,000-\$10,000 - Quartz/granite countertops: \$3,000-\$5,500 - Tile or engineered hardwood: \$1,200-\$2,400 - Designer backsplash: \$1,000-\$2,000 - Mid-range appliances: \$4,000-\$7,000 - Plumbing/electrical: \$3,500-\$5,500 - Labor: \$12,000-\$19,000 - Permits/contingency: \$5,300-\$13,600

Large Kitchen Remodel (150-200 + sq ft)

Budget-conscious (\$40,000-\$60,000): - Stock cabinets (25-30 linear ft): \$5,000-\$8,000 - Laminate/quartz countertops (60 sq ft): \$1,500-\$4,000 - Vinyl/basic tile flooring (180 sq ft): \$1,200-\$2,000 - Backsplash (50 sq ft): \$600-\$1,200 - Budget appliances: \$3,000-\$5,000 - Plumbing/electrical: \$3,000-\$5,000 - Labor: \$15,000-\$22,000 - Permits/contingency: \$6,700-\$12,800

Mid-range (\$60,000-\$90,000): - Semi-custom cabinets: \$8,000-\$14,000 - Quartz/granite countertops: \$4,000-\$7,000 - Quality tile or hardwood: \$2,000-\$3,500 - Designer backsplash: \$1,500-\$3,000 - Mid-range appliances: \$5,000-\$8,000 - Plumbing/electrical with upgrades: \$4,500-\$7,500 - Labor: \$20,000-\$30,000 - Permits/contingency: \$10,000-\$17,000

High-end (\$90,000-\$150,000 +): - Custom cabinets: \$15,000-\$40,000 + - Premium countertops (marble, quartzite): \$6,000-\$15,000 - Hardwood or luxury tile: \$3,500-\$6,000 - Custom backsplash: \$2,500-\$6,000 - High-end appliances: \$9,000-\$25,000 - Extensive plumbing/electrical: \$7,000-\$12,000 - Labor: \$25,000-\$40,000 - Permits/contingency: \$15,000-\$30,000

Where Contractors Pad Quotes the Most

Based on analysis of thousands of quotes, here's where padding is most common:

1. Labor Hours

The scam: Quoting 80 hours for cabinet installation that should take 20.

How to catch it: Ask for task-specific labor estimates and compare to industry standards.

2. Material Markups

The scam: Charging \$8,000 for cabinets they purchased for \$3,000.

How to catch it: Research the specific products they're quoting and verify retail prices. Reasonable markup is 20-40%.

3. "Project Management" Fees

The scam: Adding 15-20% "project management" on top of general contractor fees.

How to catch it: GC overhead should be built into their rates, not an extra line item. If it's separate, it should be 5-10% max and clearly defined.

4. Vague Contingency

The scam: 20% contingency that's never itemized or returned if unused.

How to catch it: Contingency should be 10-15% max and only charged if issues arise (with

documentation).

5. Inflated Demo Costs

The scam: \$4,000 for demolition that takes one day with a 2-person crew.

How to catch it: Demo typically costs \$1,000-\$2,500 for average kitchen. If it's higher, ask why.

6. Permit Fees

The scam: Charging \$1,200 for permits that actually cost \$300.

How to catch it: Call your local building department and ask what permits are required and their cost.

Money-Saving Tips That Don't Sacrifice Quality

You can reduce costs without compromising the integrity of your remodel:

1. Keep the Layout

Moving plumbing and electrical is expensive (\$3,000-\$10,000+). If you can work with your existing layout, you'll save significantly.

2. Reface Instead of Replace Cabinets

If your cabinet boxes are solid, refacing (new doors, drawer fronts, veneering the frames) costs 40-50% less than full replacement.

Cost: \$4,000-\$9,000 vs. \$8,000-\$20,000 for new cabinets

3. Choose Stock or Semi-Custom Cabinets

Custom cabinets cost 2-3x more than semi-custom with minimal functional difference for most homeowners.

4. Buy Appliances Yourself

Contractors often mark up appliances 20-30%. Buy directly during holiday sales (Memorial Day, Black Friday, Labor Day) and save \$1,000-\$3,000.

5. Do Your Own Demo

If you're handy, demolition is labor-intensive but not technically difficult. Doing it yourself saves \$1,000-\$2,500.

What you'll need: - Dumpster rental (\$400-\$800) - Basic tools (pry bars, hammer, utility knife)

- Safety gear (gloves, goggles, dust mask) - 1-3 days of hard work

6. Choose Quartz Over Marble

Quartz looks nearly identical to marble but costs 30-50% less and requires no maintenance.

7. Limit Tile Patterns

Simple tile layouts (subway, herringbone) cost less in labor than intricate mosaics or custom patterns.

8. Paint Cabinets Instead of Replacing

Professional cabinet painting costs \$3,000-\$8,000 vs. \$10,000-\$30,000 for new cabinets. If your cabinets are structurally sound, this is a huge savings.

9. Use Open Shelving Strategically

Open shelves cost significantly less than upper cabinets. Use them for 20-30% of upper storage to save \$1,000-\$3,000.

10. Get Multiple Quotes

This is obvious but critical. Three quotes from licensed, insured contractors will show you the market range and highlight outliers.

Timeline Expectations: How Long Should It Take?

Understanding timeline helps you spot contractors who are padding hours or dragging out projects.

Small Kitchen (70-100 sq ft)

Timeline: 3-5 weeks

- Week 1: Demo, rough plumbing/electrical
- Week 2: Drywall repair, cabinet installation
- Week 3: Countertops templated and installed
- Week 4: Flooring, backsplash, painting
- Week 5: Final trim, appliances, punch list

Medium Kitchen (100-150 sq ft)

Timeline: 4-7 weeks

- Week 1: Demo and rough work
- Week 2-3: Plumbing/electrical, cabinets

- Week 4: Countertops
- Week 5: Flooring and backsplash
- Week 6: Painting and trim
- Week 7: Appliances, fixtures, final touches

Large Kitchen (150-200 + sq ft)

Timeline: 6-10 weeks

- Week 1-2: Demo, structural work, rough plumbing/electrical
- Week 3-4: Cabinet installation
- Week 5: Countertop template and installation
- Week 6-7: Flooring, backsplash
- Week 8: Painting, trim work
- Week 9: Appliance installation, final electrical/plumbing
- Week 10: Punch list and final inspection

Red flag: If a contractor says a small kitchen will take 12 weeks, they're either overbooked (working on multiple jobs simultaneously) or padding the timeline.

Verify Your Kitchen Remodel Quote

You've got the numbers. You know what each component should cost. But analyzing a 15-page quote with dozens of line items is still overwhelming.

That's exactly why we built **Ungouge.ai**.

How it works: 1. **Upload your kitchen remodel quote** - Any format: PDF, spreadsheet, photo, email 2. **Our AI analyzes every line item** - We compare materials, labor rates, and markups to real market data 3. **Get a detailed breakdown** - See exactly what's fair, what's high, and where you're potentially being overcharged 4. **No email required, no sales pitch** - We're not connecting you with contractors or generating leads. Just giving you the truth.

Try it now: ungouge.ai

Final Thoughts: Invest Wisely, Not Blindly

A kitchen remodel is one of the most significant investments you'll make in your home. The ROI can be excellent—but only if you're not overpaying by 30-50%.

The data in this guide gives you the foundation to evaluate quotes intelligently. You now know:
- What each component should cost - Where contractors commonly pad quotes - How to save money without sacrificing quality - What timeline is reasonable

Get multiple quotes. Ask questions. Verify costs. And don't let complexity be used as a smokescreen for overcharging.

Your kitchen. Your money. Your call.

Know your numbers. Build with confidence.